



DDS MARINE GROUP

DDS WEEKLY MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

TANKERS | ENERGY | STS | COMPLIANCE

Insight. Safety. Excellence.



ISSUE 001

31 JULY 2026

Prepared by DDS Marine Group

Malaysia / Southeast Asia Focus — Prepared for Professional Circulation



EXECUTIVE MARKET DASHBOARD

Executive Market Dashboard

Market snapshot: 31 July 2026 | Freight narrative based on latest public weekly data

BRENT CRUDE US\$85.98/bbl ▼ 1.03% d/d	WTI CRUDE US\$82.47/bbl ▼ 1.34% d/d	SINGAPORE VLSFO US\$830.50/mt ▲ US\$14.50
SINGAPORE MGO US\$1,224.50/mt ▲ US\$19.50	US CRUDE STOCKS 404.5m bbl ▼ 7.2m bbl w/w	AG TANKER COUNT 728 vessels ▲ Week 29 (Hormuz)



DDS VIEW

The tanker complex remains dominated by geopolitical risk rather than a conventional seasonal pattern. Crude prices have eased from the week's spike, but the operational risk premium remains embedded in voyage planning, insurance, bunkers and vessel availability. Red Sea and Hormuz uncertainty continues to support longer-routing scenarios and can tighten effective tonnage supply even when headline cargo flows remain intact. For Southeast Asian operators, the immediate commercial focus is disciplined counterparty screening, documented AIS and routing decisions, verified insurance, sanctions checks immediately before fixture and operation, and explicit allocation of war-risk costs in charter-party and service contracts.

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This Week at a Glance

- ◆ **Oil:** Brent US\$85.98/bbl and WTI US\$82.47/bbl on 31 July after an exceptionally volatile month.
- ◆ **Bunkers:** Singapore VLSFO US\$830.50/mt and MGO US\$1,224.50/mt on 30 July; fuel costs remain a major voyage-economics variable.
- ◆ **Fleet positioning:** 728 tankers tracked around the Arabian Gulf in Week 29, including 123 VLCCs, 34 Suezmaxes and 18 Aframax/LR2 units in the crude segment.
- ◆ **Compliance:** OFAC added 10 entities and eight tankers in an Iran-related action on 29 July; screening must be repeated close to execution.
- ◆ **Route security:** tankers carrying Saudi crude to India switched off AIS while transiting the Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb for stated safety reasons, illustrating the conflict between navigational security and compliance transparency.



CEO MARKET COMMENTARY

CEO Market Commentary

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC — Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

“The present tanker market is not simply a freight market; it is a risk-allocation market.”

Freight, insurance, bunkers, routing, sanctions exposure and operational readiness are now moving together. A fixture that appears attractive on headline freight can become commercially weak if war-risk premiums, deviation time, security requirements or delayed port clearances are not allocated clearly before performance.

The Middle East remains the centre of global crude tanker risk. However, the impact is international: Asian refiners are adjusting procurement terms, owners are reassessing routes, insurers are repricing exposure, and charterers are demanding greater documentary certainty. The result is a market in which dependable operational execution is as valuable as access to tonnage.

For Malaysia and the wider Southeast Asian region, this creates both responsibility and opportunity. The region can strengthen its role as a trusted maritime and energy-services hub by combining safe STS execution, qualified local marine personnel, robust vessel screening, transparent documentation and practical coordination between owners, charterers, ports, surveyors, pilots and service providers.

DDS Marine Group's objective is to contribute practical market intelligence from an operator's perspective: not only what freight rates are doing, but what changing conditions mean for real voyages, real vessels and real operations.

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC

Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

Publication Principle

Independent operational commentary based on publicly available market information. No proprietary broker assessments are reproduced.



GLOBAL OIL MARKET

Global Oil Market

Prices, inventories and physical-market pressure

Indicator	Latest	Weekly / Contextual Reading
Brent crude	US\$85.98/bbl	Down 1.03% on 31 Jul; still about 20% higher over one month.
WTI crude	US\$82.47/bbl	Down 1.34% on 31 Jul; about 20% higher over one month.
US commercial crude stocks	404.5m bbl	Down 7.2m bbl in week ended 24 Jul; roughly 7% below five-year average.
US refinery utilisation	97.2%	High utilisation supports crude throughput but increases sensitivity to refinery outages.
US crude production	13.8m bpd	Reported steady in latest weekly data.

Market Interpretation

The decline in crude prices at month-end does not signal the removal of geopolitical risk. It reflects the market's judgment that oil continues to move despite conflict, alternative routes and defensive maritime measures. The physical market remains tight enough that refinery outages and security incidents can produce sharp product-price reactions even when crude benchmarks retreat.

The latest US inventory draw was materially larger than market expectations. Combined with refinery utilisation above 97%, this points to strong system throughput and limited tolerance for further supply or logistics disruption.



DDS BASE CASE

Oil prices remain highly volatile with a persistent geopolitical premium. A temporary easing in hostilities could pressure crude lower, but any confirmed disruption to Hormuz, Bab el-Mandeb, major export terminals or refining capacity would likely reverse that movement quickly.

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Commercial Effect on Shipping

Higher crude and bunker prices increase voyage working capital and can widen the financial consequences of delays. Owners and charterers should verify bunker clauses, deviation treatment, war-risk premiums, additional insurance, security costs and responsibility for waiting time before finalising fixture terms.

CRUDE TANKER MARKET



Crude Tanker Market

VLCC, Suezmax and Aframax directional assessment

Segment	Current Tone	Primary Driver
VLCC	Firm / highly volatile	AG security, voyage length, tonnage positioning
Suezmax	Firm	Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb and Atlantic alternatives
Aframax	Firm but regional	Mediterranean, Red Sea, Black Sea and regional crude flows

VLCC

Public fleet-tracking analysis for Week 29 identified 123 VLCCs within the crude tanker population around the Arabian Gulf, representing 68.7% of crude tankers recorded in that area. This concentration means that any restriction, security delay or insurance constraint around Hormuz can rapidly affect a large share of global crude-carrying capacity.

The commercial signal is supportive but unstable. Owners with acceptable risk profiles and clear routing can command a premium; charterers must distinguish between nominal vessel availability and vessels that are operationally, legally and commercially executable.

Suezmax

Suezmax demand is being supported by its ability to move approximately one-million-barrel parcels and by route changes affecting Red Sea, Mediterranean and Atlantic Basin flows. A reported Suezmax voyage carrying Saudi crude to India, including a period without public AIS transmission for stated safety reasons, highlights the operational complexity now affecting this segment.

Aframax

Aframax earnings remain strongly linked to regional dislocation. The segment can benefit from replacement barrels, port limitations and shorter-haul movements, but it is also highly exposed to local security and congestion. Prompt position and clean compliance history are increasingly important differentiators.



DDS VIEW

Our assessment is that VLCC freight is likely to remain supported over the coming two weeks. Effective tonnage around the Arabian Gulf is still being constrained by routing caution and insurance conditions rather than genuine scarcity, and with 68.7% of the Week 29 AG crude tanker count concentrated in the VLCC segment, any incremental security or sanctions friction has an outsized effect on headline availability. We would not read a quiet week on Hormuz as a reason to relax screening or war-risk allocation — the premium is compensating for a risk that has not gone away.

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CLEAN & PRODUCT TANKERS


Clean & Product Tankers

LR2, MR and refining-margin implications

Product tanker fundamentals are receiving support from refinery disruption and exceptionally strong fuel cracks. Reuters reported European diesel refining margins near record levels and elevated gasoline and jet-fuel margins as refinery outages reduced available product supply.

Segment	Opportunity	Risk
LR2	Long-haul middle-distillate and naphtha movements; benefits from Middle East/Asia dislocation.	High bunker exposure; route security; overlap with Aframax trading economics.
MR	Flexible regional distribution and replacement cargoes.	Port congestion, volatile prompt lists and fast-changing arbitrage economics.
Handy / Specialised	Regional supply, chemicals and smaller-port access.	Cargo compatibility, vetting, tank cleanliness and parcel-specific documentation.


DDS VIEW

The key product-tanker question is whether high refining margins translate into sustained export runs or are offset by refinery outages and feedstock constraints. In the near term, supply dislocation is supportive for tonne-mile demand, particularly where replacement products must move from more distant refining centres. For charterers, freight should be evaluated alongside cargo value, financing cost and demurrage exposure. For owners, cargo quality, terminal readiness and documentary completeness remain essential because the commercial value of prompt availability can be lost quickly through avoidable delays.

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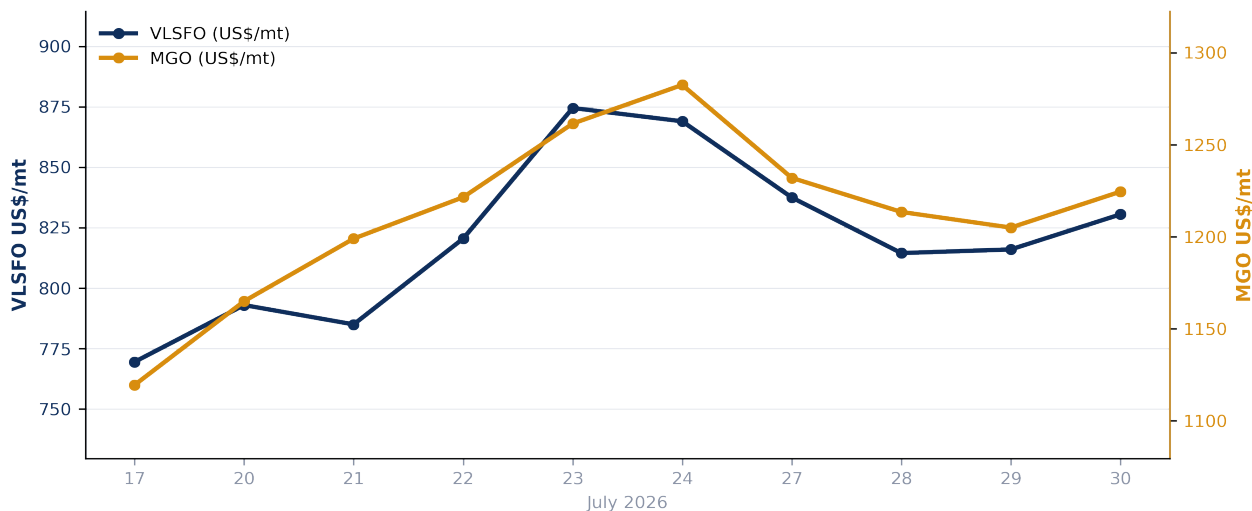
Operating Checklist

- ◆ Confirm cargo specification and compatibility before nomination.
- ◆ Validate terminal restrictions, manifold size and reducer requirements.
- ◆ Recheck sanctions and beneficial ownership immediately before fixture and loading.
- ◆ Allocate additional war-risk and deviation costs expressly.
- ◆ Maintain complete SOF, NOR, pumping and delay records for claims protection.


BUNKER MARKET — SINGAPORE

Bunker Market — Singapore

Daily indications in US\$/mt, 17–30 July 2026



Date	VLSFO	MGO	VLSFO Daily Change
17 Jul	769.50	1,119.50	–11.00
20 Jul	793.00	1,165.00	+23.50
21 Jul	785.00	1,199.00	–8.00
22 Jul	820.50	1,221.50	+35.50
23 Jul	874.50	1,261.50	+54.00
24 Jul	869.00	1,282.50	–5.50
27 Jul	837.50	1,232.00	–31.50
28 Jul	814.50	1,213.50	–23.00
29 Jul	816.00	1,205.00	+1.50
30 Jul	830.50	1,224.50	+14.50

Interpretation

Singapore VLSFO ended 30 July at US\$830.50/mt, below the 24 July level of US\$869.00/mt but still US\$61.00/mt above 17 July. MGO ended at US\$1,224.50/mt, US\$105.00/mt above 17 July. The resulting fuel-cost volatility materially affects long ballast legs, waiting time, deviation economics and STS-support craft costs.



DDS RECOMMENDATION

Use current bunker indications at the time of voyage calculation, not a weekly average; include a sensitivity range for at least $\pm$ US\$50/mt on VLSFO and $\pm$ US\$100/mt on MGO for exposed voyages.

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GEOPOLITICAL & ROUTE RISK

Geopolitical & Route Risk

Hormuz, Red Sea, Bab el-Mandeb and Black Sea

Area	Current Signal	Commercial Consequence
Strait of Hormuz	Traffic remains possible but security and sanctions risk remain elevated.	Insurance, routing approval, crew welfare, owner consent and possible delay.
Red Sea / Bab el-Mandeb	Saudi cargoes and other vessels face Houthi-related threat and rerouting decisions.	Longer voyages, AIS/security dilemmas, possible delivered-basis procurement.
Black Sea / CPC	Attacks and terminal interruptions threaten export reliability.	Replacement barrels, voyage disruption and higher regional tanker demand.
Eastern Mediterranean	Security spillover and refinery disruption affect products and insurance.	Higher product cracks, altered flows and additional voyage due diligence.

AIS and War-Zone Operations

AIS transmission decisions in conflict zones create a difficult balance. Safety considerations may justify temporary measures under applicable rules and flag/company procedures, but unexplained AIS gaps are also a recognised sanctions and compliance red flag. Every decision should be documented by the master and company, supported by a formal risk assessment, and communicated to relevant parties where safe and legally appropriate.

Charter-Party Protection

Contracts should identify who bears additional war-risk premium, Kidnap & Ransom cover, security personnel, deviation fuel, time lost awaiting routing permission, convoy or escort requirements, and any additional port or agency costs. General wording is often insufficient during fast-moving security events.

DDS RISK LEVEL: HIGH — The market remains executable, but no Middle East or Red Sea fixture should proceed on commercial assumptions alone. Operational, insurance, sanctions and route approvals should be treated as conditions precedent.



SANCTIONS & COMPLIANCE WATCH

Sanctions & Compliance Watch

Actionable controls for fixtures and STS operations

Regulatory Developments — Week Ending 31 July 2026

- ◆ **United States (OFAC):** On 29 July 2026, OFAC announced a new Iran-related package targeting 10 entities and 8 tankers connected to efforts to monetize shipping through the Strait of Hormuz. The action also included companies based in China and maritime insurance-related entities.
- ◆ **European Union:** The 21st sanctions package, adopted on 23 July 2026, expanded restrictions on Russia's shadow-fleet ecosystem, including shipping support companies, oil-sector entities, refineries, traders and maritime service providers.

Editorial & Verification Note

For legal and accuracy reasons, DDS Marine Group publishes officially designated vessel names, IMO numbers and ownership details only after verifying them directly against the latest OFAC SDN list and the EU Official Journal, rather than relying on secondary summaries. This keeps DDS credible and reduces the risk of publishing incorrect compliance information.

Earlier in July, OFAC issued Iran General License Z covering specified wind-down, safety/environmental transactions and offloading involving certain persons or vessels blocked on 14 July.

Control	Minimum Action
Vessel screening	Screen IMO, current and former names, flag history, ownership, management, operator and ISM company.
Counterparty KYC	Verify beneficial ownership, directors, trading history, address, banking and sanctions nexus.
AIS history	Review dark periods, spoofing indicators, abnormal loitering, repeated STS patterns and identity changes.
Cargo origin	Obtain documentary chain: supplier, terminal, bill of lading, certificate of origin and payment route.
Insurance	Confirm P&I; status, war-risk cover, trading limits and sanctions clauses directly where necessary.
Pre-operation refresh	Repeat screening immediately before nomination, fixture, arrival and commencement of STS/cargo operations.
Record preservation	Keep screenshots, reports, approvals, emails, SOF and operational instructions in the job file.

Important

A vessel being absent from one sanctions list does not automatically make the transaction acceptable. Exposure can arise through ownership, control, cargo origin, counterparties, insurers, banks, deceptive shipping practices or local-law restrictions. Complex cases require qualified sanctions counsel and bank/insurer confirmation.



SHADOW FLEET WATCH

Shadow Fleet Watch

A recurring weekly tracker — launching with Issue 001

Starting this issue, DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence introduces a standing Shadow Fleet Watch section. Each week's tracker will cover the categories below.

- ◆ Newly sanctioned vessels
- ◆ Flag changes
- ◆ Name changes
- ◆ Ownership changes
- ◆ Manager changes
- ◆ ISM company changes
- ◆ Recent dark AIS activity
- ◆ High-risk STS activity
- ◆ High-risk ports
- ◆ High-risk cargo origins
- ◆ New OFAC advisories
- ◆ EU advisories
- ◆ UK OFSI advisories

Status — Issue 001

This issue's entries are pending verification against primary sanctions sources. Consistent with the Editorial & Verification Note on the preceding page, named vessels, IMO numbers and ownership details will appear once confirmed against the official OFAC SDN list, the EU Official Journal and UK OFSI notices.



DDS COMPLIANCE RATING

DDS Compliance Rating

A consistent risk rating applied to every vessel named in DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence



Low Risk



Medium Risk



High Risk



Sanctioned / Do Not Fix

How the Rating Works

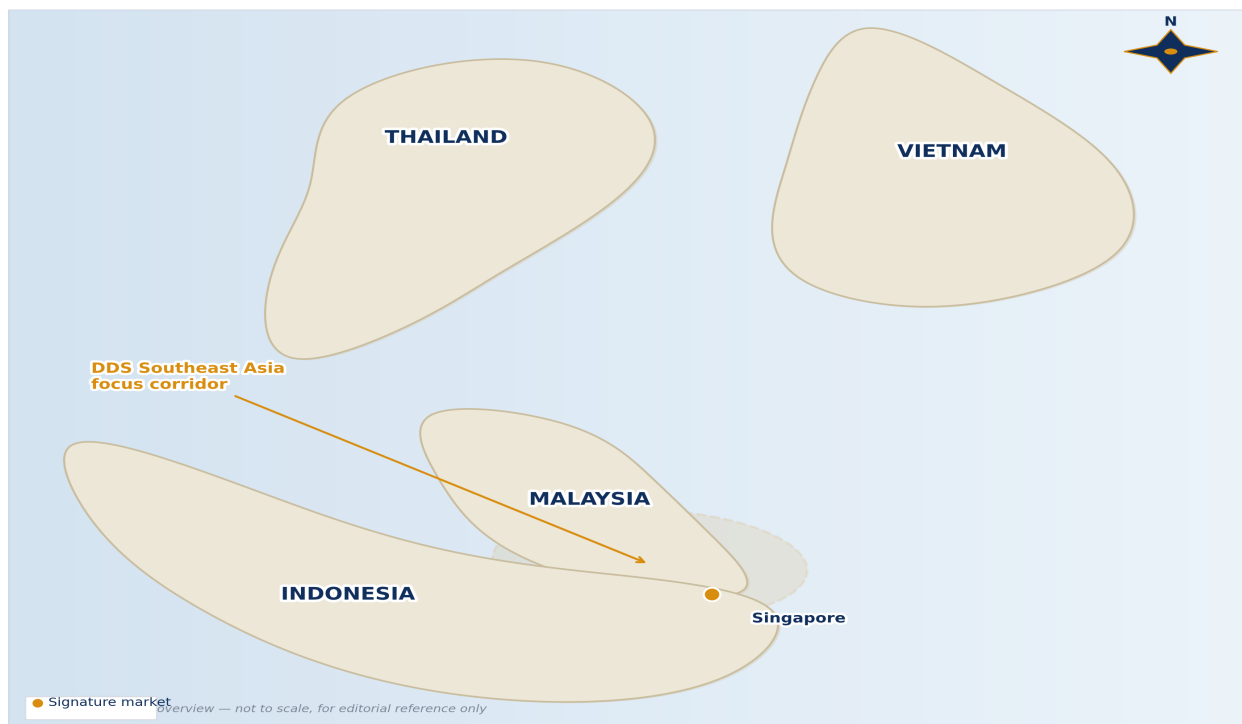
Every vessel referenced in a DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence report — whether in the Shadow Fleet Watch, a route-risk item or a market commentary — will carry one of the four ratings above, assigned only once the underlying screening (sanctions lists, AIS history, ownership and flag checks) has been completed against primary sources.



SOUTHEAST ASIA SIGNATURE

Southeast Asia — the DDS Signature Region

Malaysia · Singapore · Indonesia · Thailand · Vietnam



Global tanker coverage is well served for the Middle East, the Atlantic Basin and North Asia. It is far less well served for the waters DDS Marine Group operates in every day: the Strait of Malacca, the Singapore Strait and the STS anchorages of southern Johor. This is deliberately becoming the signature region of DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence.

Market	Why It Matters to Tanker & STS Operators
Malaysia	Home to Port Klang, Malacca, Muar, Linggi and the Johor STS/bunkering corridor; the physical base of DDS Marine Group's operations.
Singapore	The region's principal bunkering, storage and blending hub, and the reference point for Malacca/Singapore Strait transit risk.
Indonesia	Batam and Karimun sit directly opposite the Singapore Strait and are active in STS, bunkering and offshore support.
Thailand	Gulf of Thailand product distribution and a secondary routing option for regional crude and clean cargoes.
Vietnam	Growing product-import demand and a bellwether for intra-Asia clean tanker and MR trading patterns.

**DDS VIEW**

Our house view is that Southeast Asia's importance to global tanker markets is rising faster than its media coverage. As Middle East routing becomes less predictable, Malacca/Singapore Strait transit patterns, STS scheduling and Johor-corridor throughput are an early, practical signal of how owners and charterers are actually adjusting — often before it shows up in headline freight assessments. Readers who want a first read on Southeast Asia should expect to find it here first.

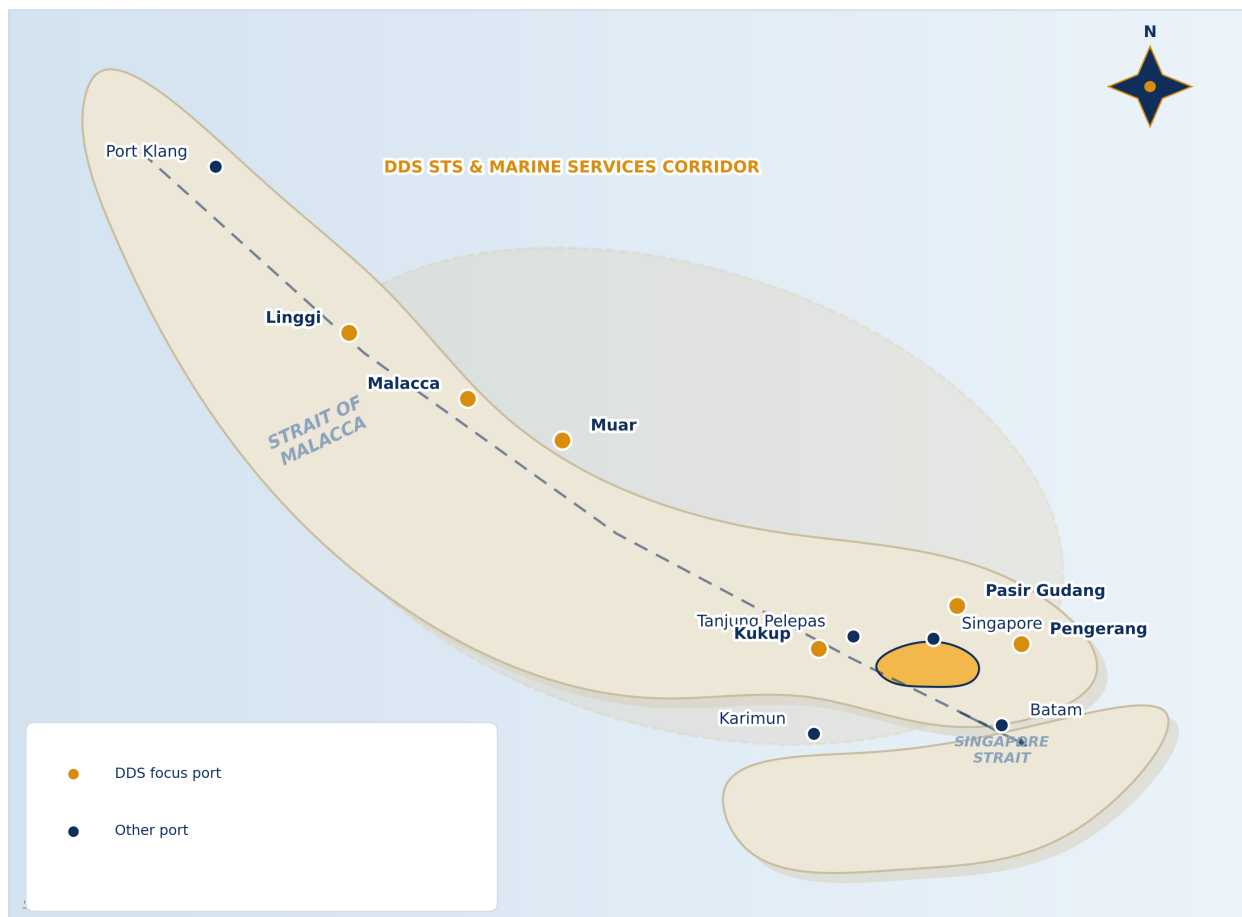
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MUAR & JOHOR STS CORRIDOR

Muar & Johor STS Corridor

Malacca · Linggi · Muar · Kukup · Pasir Gudang · Pengerang



The Malacca-to-Pengerang corridor along Malaysia's southern and western Johor coastline is where DDS Marine Group carries out the bulk of its own STS and marine-services work, and where this publication intends to go deeper than any generalist tanker report.

Location	DDS Operator Notes
Malacca	Established anchorage and STS ground on the northern approach to the Strait; historically active for coastal and regional tonnage.
Linggi	Sheltered anchorage used for STS and lay-up support along the Negeri Sembilan/Malacca coast.
Muar	A core DDS operating area; used for STS transfers and marine support serving the central Malacca Strait.
Kukup	Southernmost Johor anchorage close to the Malaysia–Indonesia boundary in the Strait, relevant to cross-border STS coordination.
Pasir Gudang	Established port and anchorage on the Johor Strait, serving bulk, liquid and STS-support traffic.
Pengerang	Integrated petroleum hub anchorage on Johor's southeastern tip, positioned for both Malacca Strait and South China Sea traffic.

**DDS VIEW**

This corridor is DDS Marine Group's home ground, and we intend for it to become the most closely documented stretch of water in regional tanker reporting — STS scheduling patterns, anchorage usage and vessel-compatibility issues that owners and charterers currently have to source directly from local operators. Expect Muar and the wider Johor corridor to carry a dedicated page in every future issue.

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THIS WEEK'S FIXTURES This Week's Fixtures

Week 30 (to 27 July 2026) — reported clean and dirty tanker fixtures

Clean Tanker Fixtures

Cargo	Size (kt)	POL	POD	Rate	Laycan	Vessel
CL	35	Yanbu	EMED	\$1.4m	23 Jul	Philoxenia
CL	35	Japan	Aus	W307.5	26 Jul	Petrel Pacific
UNL	30	Barcelona	Cont	W180	25 Jul	Hafnia Azotic
CL	38	USGC	TA	W275	22 Jul	Delos C

Dirty Tanker Fixtures

Cargo	Size (kt)	POL	POD	Rate	Laycan	Vessel
CR	80	Seria	Muara	\$750k	6 Aug	Pusaka Jaya
CR	135	CPC	UKC	W267.5	6 Aug	Advantage Smooth
CR	80	Vancouver	China	\$3.1m	3 Aug	Yuan Tang Wan

Segment Sentiment

Segment	Trading Pattern	Market Sentiment (Week 30)
VLCC	AG / East, Atlantic	Mixed — AG-China firming, Atlantic routes softened.
Suezmax	AG, West Africa, Black Sea	Steady.
Aframax	Regional, Atlantic Basin	Rallied, particularly in the Atlantic region.
LR	Key long-haul routes	Firmed across key routes and regions.
MR	AG, USGC, intra-Asia	Mixed — gains in AG, firmness in USGC.
Handymax	Med, UKC	Gained steadily across Med and UKC.

Fixtures and segment sentiment sourced from ILCCPL Weekly Trend, Week 30 (27 July 2026), reproduced here with attribution as broker market colour.



BROKER MARKET WIRE

Broker Market Wire — Week 30

External market colour, reproduced with attribution to ILCCPL

Crude & Refined Markets

- ◆ Oil slipped roughly 5% as the U.S. and Iran halted attacks, with Brent trading at US\$91.80/bbl and WTI at US\$84.47/bbl.
- ◆ Saudi Red Sea crude exports from Yanbu fell 41% to just 2.4 mbbbl/day by June, down from 4 mbbbl/day.
- ◆ India's state refiners are looking to Angola and Venezuela for crude as Middle East supply is strained amid conflict.
- ◆ Chinese refiners bought all Russian crude cargoes loading from Kozmino as Middle East supply risks rise.

Freight

- ◆ VLCC spot trend was mixed, with AG-China routes firming while Atlantic routes softened.
- ◆ Suezmax freight remained steady; Aframax demand rallied, particularly in the Atlantic region.
- ◆ LR spot demand firmed across key routes and regions.
- ◆ MR freight saw mixed sentiment, with gains in the AG and firmness in the USGC.
- ◆ Handymax gained steadily across the Med and UKC regions.



DDS VIEW

A 41% fall in Yanbu Red Sea loadings since June is a material redirection of Saudi crude flows, and it lines up with what we are seeing on the compliance side: India and China are both actively re-routing toward Atlantic Basin and Russian Far East barrels rather than absorbing more Middle East risk. For owners and charterers active in our region, this points to firmer long-haul demand on routes that displace, rather than replace, Middle East cargo — exactly the kind of shift that shows up first in fixture and TC-rate data before it reaches headline commentary.

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Markets Snapshot

Currencies	Closing
GBP/USD	1.34
EUR/USD	1.14
USD/CNY	6.77

Equities	Closing
S&P 500	7,411.98
FTSE 100	10,736.23
SSE Index	3,814.20



Insights, fixtures and market levels in this section are reproduced with attribution from Intracontinent Logichem Corporation Private Limited (ILCCPL), "ILCCPL Weekly Trend, Week 30", 27 July 2026. DDS Marine Group does not take responsibility for the accuracy of third-party broker data.



PORT INTELLIGENCE

Port Intelligence

Singapore, Malaysia and the Riau Islands — weekly status

Port	This Week's Status
Singapore	7-day average vessel waiting time around 1.2 days; yard utilisation around 80%, warranting continued monitoring of terminal capacity.
Tanjung Pelepas	No material disruption reported this week; monitored as a key transshipment alternative to Singapore.
Pasir Gudang	No material disruption reported this week; STS and bulk/liquid throughput tracked as part of the Johor corridor.
Pengerang	No material disruption reported this week; petroleum-hub berth and anchorage activity monitored.
Muar	No material disruption reported this week; DDS-operated STS ground under direct monitoring.
Port Klang	No material disruption reported this week; tracked as a Malacca Strait routing reference point.
Batam	No material disruption reported this week; monitored for STS and bunkering activity opposite the Singapore Strait.
Karimun	No material disruption reported this week; monitored for STS and anchorage use on the southern Strait.
Labuan	Tracked separately as DDS's East Malaysia / South China Sea reference port for offshore support and bunkering activity.

Singapore figures per public port-operations reporting for the week of 22–28 July 2026; other entries reflect DDS's own monitoring and will be expanded with anchorage-level detail as reporting matures.



DDS SHIPBROKING

DDS Shipbroking

Reporting template — launching alongside DDS Shipbroking

About This Section

As DDS builds out its shipbroking desk, this section will carry a weekly round-up structured around the five panels below. The framework is set out here in Issue 001; entries will populate from upcoming issues.

Cargoes

Fresh cargo enquiries and confirmed stems reported to DDS Shipbroking during the week, by segment and load area.

Open Ships

Vessels reporting open or expected open within the region, by class and prompt date.

Market Balance

DDS's read on the balance between reported cargo enquiries and open tonnage, by segment.

Ballasters

Vessels ballasting into the region and their expected arrival window.

Position List

A consolidated position list of tonnage tracked by DDS Shipbroking across the Malacca/Singapore Strait and wider Southeast Asia.



COMPLIANCE INTELLIGENCE ROADMAP

Compliance Intelligence — Roadmap

Where the Sanctions & Compliance Watch section is heading

Issue 001 launches Sanctions & Compliance Watch, Shadow Fleet Watch and the DDS Compliance Rating. DDS intends to grow this into the most detailed compliance-intelligence section of any Southeast Asian tanker publication, expanding coverage issue by issue to include the areas below.

- ◆ Full OFAC, EU, UK OFSI and UN designation tracking, cross-referenced against primary sources
- ◆ Shadow fleet vessel, owner and manager watchlists, verified before publication
- ◆ A standing High-Risk Owners register
- ◆ A standing High-Risk Managers & ISM Companies register
- ◆ Dark-AIS incident logs by route and date
- ◆ P&I and war-risk insurance market notes relevant to sanctioned and high-risk trades

**DDS VIEW**

We would rather expand this section deliberately, issue by issue, than publish an unverified register on day one. Every addition above will only go live once DDS has a repeatable process for checking it against the official OFAC SDN list, the EU Official Journal and UK OFSI notices — the same discipline set out in this issue's Editorial & Verification Note.

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SOUTHEAST ASIA & STS OPERATIONS

Southeast Asia & STS Operations

Practical operator's focus

Southeast Asia remains strategically important for energy redistribution, bunkering, storage, blending, crew support and ship-to-ship operations. Market opportunity must be matched by visible standards of safety, documentation and compliance.

Operational Pillar	DDS Standard
Planning	Job-specific JPO, risk assessment, mooring plan, weather limits, communications plan and emergency response.
Vessel suitability	Compatibility review covering freeboard, manifold, fenders, hoses, mooring arrangement, vetting and cargo system.
Personnel	Qualified POAC/mooring master, pilots, surveyors, launch crew, tug support and clear command/reporting lines.
Equipment	Certificates, pressure tests, inspection records, safe working loads, reducer compatibility and pre-use checks.
Control room	Real-time coordination with port/VTMS, owners, charterers, cargo interests, agents, tugs and service providers.
Documentation	Accurate NOR, SOF, checklists, pumping records, delay evidence, photographs and final operation report.

Market Opportunity

Current volatility increases demand for reliable regional operators that can combine marine execution with compliance awareness. DDS should position its market intelligence as an extension of its operational service: practical, documented and focused on reducing execution risk.

Brand objective: establish DDS as a recognised Southeast Asian source for tanker, STS and operational intelligence while maintaining a clear distinction between independent commentary and licensed proprietary market assessments.



SEVEN-DAY OUTLOOK

Seven-Day Outlook — 1–7 August 2026

Market	Base Case	Upside Risk	Downside Risk
Crude oil	Volatile US\$80–95/bbl trading environment.	Confirmed export disruption, refinery/terminal attack or Hormuz restriction.	Diplomatic progress and sustained safe traffic.
VLCC	Firm but highly headline-sensitive.	Reduced effective tonnage through routing/insurance constraints.	Cargo delays or easing security premium.
Suezmax	Firm with route-driven support.	More Red Sea avoidance and Atlantic replacement flows.	Improved passage security and softer cargo programme.
Aframax	Regional firmness.	Black Sea/Med disruption and prompt replacement demand.	Tonnage build-up in local basins.
Products	Supportive due to refinery outages and high cracks.	Further refinery disruption and long-haul replacement cargoes.	Rapid refinery recovery or weaker end-user demand.
Bunkers	Remain elevated and volatile.	Crude spike or local supply tightness.	Oil-price retreat and improved logistics.

Watch List

- ◆ Any formal change in navigation conditions through Hormuz or Bab el-Mandeb.
- ◆ New sanctions designations affecting vessels, insurers, managers or cargo networks.
- ◆ Saudi and regional export-routing decisions.
- ◆ Black Sea/CPC terminal status.
- ◆ Singapore VLSFO and MGO direction after the late-July volatility.
- ◆ Evidence that high product cracks are generating additional long-haul tanker demand.



DDS CONCLUSION

The market remains commercially attractive for prepared participants, but unusually expensive for unprepared ones. The strongest competitive advantage over the coming week is not speculation on headline rates; it is the ability to execute safely, document decisions and control compliance, insurance and delay exposure.

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From Weekly PDF to Intelligence Platform

Rather than a simple PDF every Friday, DDS Maritime Intelligence is becoming a publication people subscribe to.

- ◆ Live oil market analysis
- ◆ Port intelligence
- ◆ STS market analysis
- ◆ Shadow fleet intelligence
- ◆ AIS risk analysis
- ◆ Weekly CEO commentary
- ◆ Freight market commentary
- ◆ Bunker prices
- ◆ Verified sanctions database with IMO numbers
- ◆ OFAC, EU, UK and UN updates
- ◆ Vessel screening notes

The Opportunity

Over time, this becomes a proprietary DDS knowledge base that supports both your clients and your own commercial and STS operations — combining live market data, a verified sanctions database, shadow fleet intelligence and weekly CEO commentary in one subscriber platform.



METHODOLOGY, SOURCES & DISCLAIMER

Methodology, Sources & Disclaimer

Issue 001

DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence combines public market data, official regulatory releases, reputable news reporting and operator-focused analysis. Freight commentary is directional and does not reproduce proprietary broker assessments or subscription-only indices.

Source	Information Used
Trading Economics, 31 Jul 2026	Brent US\$85.98/bbl; WTI US\$82.47/bbl; daily and monthly movements.
U.S. EIA Weekly Petroleum Status Report, 29 Jul 2026	US commercial crude inventories 404.5m bbl; weekly draw 7.2m bbl; five-year comparison.
Ship & Bunker, Singapore prices through 30 Jul 2026	VLSFO and MGO daily indications and recent history.
The Signal Group / AXSMarine, Week 29	728 tankers around Arabian Gulf; crude-tanker class distribution.
U.S. Treasury OFAC, 14 & 29 Jul 2026	Iran General License Z, SDN update and 29 July designations.
European Union, 23 Jul 2026	21st sanctions package — Russia shadow-fleet ecosystem restrictions.
Reuters, 29–30 Jul 2026	New Iran-related sanctions; tanker routing/AIS events; oil and refinery-market developments.
Baltic Exchange public weekly round-up, 24 Jul 2026	General weekly tanker-market context. No proprietary route values reproduced.

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